

ANI

WHEELS ARE TURNING
CM Adityanath with industry minister Nandi, finance minister Suresh Khanna and others at a GIS curtain-raiser event in Delhi

business, were a subject of discussion with all the investors he met. Talks were held with the Hinduja Group, Rolls Royce and the Hiranandani Group for big-ticket investments. The Saloni Heart Foundation in San Francisco, as part of its philanthropic initiatives, has decided to give a CSR grant of Rs 415 crore to SGPGI hospital in Lucknow. The sectors that attracted the most investment proposals were renewable energy, hotels/hospitality, skill development, logistics and IT/ITES, says the state government.

But, as the government admits, the job is only half done. As Arvind Kumar, additional chief secretary (infrastructure and industrial development), says, "The kind of response we got in our foreign tours is huge. Now we have to follow up and convert them on the ground." If the deals fructify, the government estimates it could generate more than 700,000 jobs.

For the moment, though, all focus is on the investor summit in February.

Several investors have already expressed interest, with the Ambanis and Adanis leading the show. A UP government statement says Reliance Industries chief Mukesh Ambani has proposed huge investments in electronics manufacturing and green energy sectors, including providing 5G internet connectivity across UP and better health services in the villages with the help of artificial intelligence. The Adani Group has shown interest in setting up medical colleges in Ballia and Shravasti districts on a PPP basis and a 10,000-seat capacity skill development centre in Noida. The latter may also get a major R&D project in the electronics and electric vehicles (EV) sector, with Vedanta's Anil Agarwal making a pitch.

However, this mega push for investments is not without its share of criticism, propelled by the major embarrassment that the fake 'Austin University' became. The state government had gone to town on signing an MoU with 'Austin University' in San Francisco, US, in the presence of minister Khanna and additional chief secretary Kumar. The deal was to build a Knowledge Smart City in UP, which would include the best universities of the world, at a cost of $42 billion (about Rs 35,000 crore). However, it soon came to light that the university itself was a fake one. Scrambling to cover up the gaffe, the UP government clarified on January 12 that an MoU was indeed signed, but with the equally vague 'Austin Consulting Group'. This even as the Opposition demanded that the government issue a white paper on how much foreign investment the tours had generated.

Former CM and Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav has been caustic about the government's efforts. "Where is the report card from the previous investors' conference [in 2018]? Last time, too, this BJP government had claimed MoUs worth lakhs of crores, but there is no investment visible on the ground," he says. He also criticised the ministers and officials for "going off on foreign jaunts when they couldn't raise money here", saying the result of all this is "a big zero".

Former Congress MLC Deepak

Graphic by **Tanmoy Chakraborty**

UP'S BID TO BECOME NO. 1

KEY INVESTORS

Reliance Jio Infocomm, PayTm, Samsung, Pepsico, Ultratech, NIDP (Hiranandani Group), Adani Enterprises, Sify Technologies. NTT global and STT global (data centres)

INVESTMENT EXPECTED

₹17 LAKH CRORE
Investment target for Global Investor Summit 2023

₹7.1 LAKH CRORE
Via 149 MoUs generated from foreign tours (investors from 16 countries)

₹5 LAKH CRORE
MoUs signed after Yogi's Mumbai visit

STEADY GROWTH

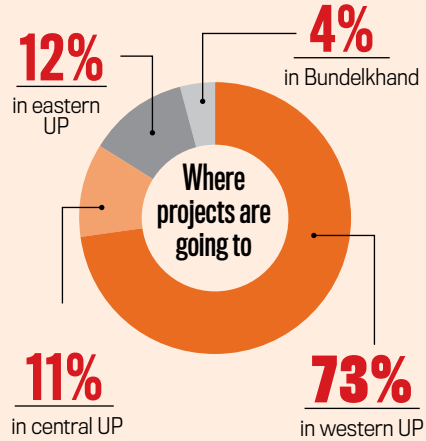
Projects worth Rs 2.09 lakh crore facilitated through three 'ground-breaking' ceremonies

July 29, 2018	July 28, 2019	June 3, 2022
81 projects worth Rs 61,800 crore	290 projects worth Rs 67,000 crore	1,406 projects worth Rs 80,000 crore

JOBS GENERATED

796,312
Opportunities created during Yogi's rule since 2017

702,415
Employment generation expected from GIS 2023



Source: Official UP government numbers